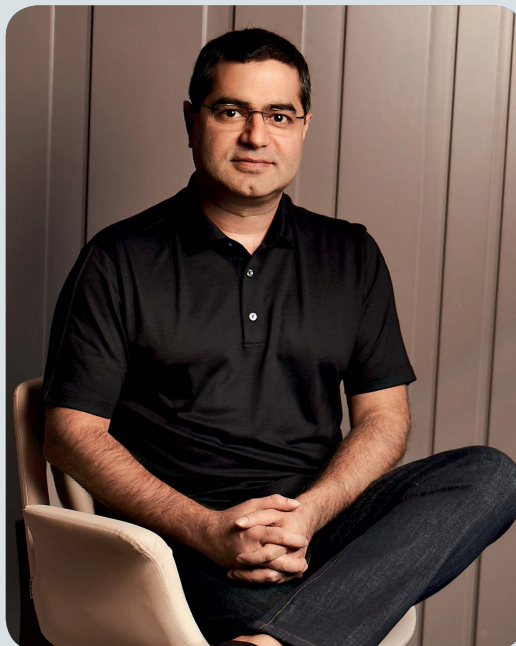




'NOW, WE CAN FULLY EMBRACE FOUNDERS'

Shailendra Singh, Managing Director of Peak XV Partners, talks about the opportunities after the split from Sequoia and much more

BY **BINU PAUL**



SEQUOIA CAPITAL

recently announced that it would be split into three entities and that the India and Southeast Asia entity would be rebranded as Peak XV Partners. The new fund is looking now to sharpen its focus on the region and take forward the rich legacy of its parent. In an interview, Managing Director *Shailendra Singh* talks about what the company can offer founders, the value proposition for limited partners (LPs) and its strategy. Edited excerpts:



On what LPs stand to gain from the split:

I've always told LPs: When you invest with us, you're investing in two broad areas. One, in the market potential of our region, which is that the economy will grow consistently, and secondly,

the innovation potential of our region—software, infrastructure, cloud computing, and artificial intelligence (AI) companies. What happened between 2018 and now is that the percentage of our

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investments in the second bucket, i.e. in the innovation potential of our region, has shifted dramatically. From 10 per cent, it became 50-55 per cent of our business. We think an Indian company will be in the Top 3 in the world in every category of software. Our objective is to be in as many of those globally relevant

Top 3 companies over the next 10 years. That's what they (LPs) will get when they invest in us. We are increasing the odds that we can be in the leading software companies that emerge from India and Southeast Asia globally.



On why founders would choose Peak XV without the Sequoia appeal:

With this rebranding, we have the ability to fully embrace and help founders, take them to global markets and help them win internationally. We will double down on cross-border [investments]. We will probably open a US office later this year. We can help them [start-ups] win all around the world by building direct capabilities to help them recruit talent in the US, land and expand customers in the US. We tell founders, 'Look we have

only one North Star, we will do everything in our power to help you win.'



On Peak XV's investment agenda for the future:

There was a period when a lot of consumer brand and tech investments were happening, followed by fintech. The current period is leaning strongly towards global software, innovation, cloud infrastructure and AI. To that extent, there has been a shift in portfolio composition from the market potential of India to innovation potential. We have signed five term sheets within the first two weeks of the rebranding. India will have a very transformational role to play in this AI wave. AI-centric opportunities are going to be a very big focus for us in the next few quarters. **BT**

@binu_t_paul